Teacher and cover plan — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Review your Week 4 identity piece against your Week 3 composition plan.

• Write down one targeted improvement before picking up a tool (edge contrast, tonal depth, or background balance).

• Carry out the named refinement and document the before-and-after impact in your studio log.

Studio kit: Week 4 identity artworks, Week 3 plans, refinement log cards, black brush pens, white gouache/chalk, coloured pencils, oil pastels

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Why do experienced artists stop and name ONE specific change out loud or in writing before they start 'fixing' a nearly finished piece?

Starter question: What is the biggest danger of adding lots of random extra marks all over a finished artwork without a plan?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Compare artwork against the Week 3 plan: I place my Week 4 artwork next to my Week 3 plan and spot that my central emblem's left edge blends into the indigo pattern.

Step 2: Write the named change on the log card: Before picking up a pen, I write: 'Change: Add a warm amber halo and thicken the outer black contour on the left side.'

Step 3: Execute the change and record the result: I add the amber rim and crisp black line, then complete the 'Impact' box explaining how the focal point now pops.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Target ticked before action, refinement applied cleanly, and log stem completed.

Independent: Written pre-action intention, executed refinement, and post-action impact evaluation.

Aspire: Two-stage refinement documented, executed, mounted, and critically evaluated.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Check that every pupil has written or ticked their intended change on their log card before handing out the black brush pens and white highlights.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review a short clip on teaching intentional refinement and preventing pupils from overworking finished pieces.